

Jobs-to-Be-Done Analysis for KOOPE (Home Cocktail/Bartending App)

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Executive summary

KOOPE is a forthcoming **mobile bartending platform** that promises a “home bar in your pocket.” It combines **liquor/ingredient scanning**, inventory management, personalized cocktail recommendations, tutorials, and a gamified “Vault” economy to help users *discover what to make and manage their bar*. Its key use-cases include finding cocktail recipes based on what you own, learning mixology techniques, and even suggesting new spirits to buy (for yourself or as gifts).

The JTBD analysis finds that **the core jobs KOOPE targets are indeed real and valued**: consumers *do* want help deciding which drinks to make (and what to buy) when facing a cluttered home bar. Leading competitors (e.g. Vivino for wine, Distiller for spirits, Noflair/My Bar for cocktails, AI bartenders like Bartender.ai and Cocktail Flow) confirm these needs. However, it is also a **crowded space**. The value is not in mere scanning or recipes (these are now table stakes) but in *contextual intelligence*: linking inventory + preferences + occasion to actionable suggestions. ([noflair.app](#), [cocktailflow.com](#), [apps.apple.com](#))

In summary, KOOPE **is well aligned with real consumer needs** (finding recipes from inventory, exploring new drinks, learning mixology) and even taps the gift-buying angle (helping choose spirits for others). The market shows demand (large user bases on analogous apps), but KOOPE must excel on its differentiated “scanner + AI + inventory-aware + gamification” combination. Generic features alone (scan ⇒ recipe) are easily replicated; success requires *unique data/UX*, like Noflair’s “scan your bottles” and personalized recs, Distiller’s “TruePrice,” or Vivino’s community scale. ¹ ²

KOOPE product overview (features)

KOOPE’s official documents/code describe it as a **tab-based app** with these pillars (citing the provided internal summary):

- **Home Bar Inventory**: Scan UPC/barcodes of your liquor/ingredients to track what you own. (Tiered limits apply – free users have a cap.)
- **Recommendations (“Discover”)**: Multiple engines (taste match, mood, seasonal) suggest cocktails. It shows what you can make with current inventory and highlights missing ingredients to expand your bar.
- **Camera/Scanner**: Barcode-first scanning (UPC/EAN) for products; fallback manual entry if not found. Tiered scanning capabilities (Free, Plus, Pro) broaden the database lookup scope.

- **Lessons/Learning:** Cocktail tutorials and techniques (progression tracked as XP). Tier-gated “Mastery” content, with spaced-repetition quiz features to teach mixology basics (similar to a bartender course).
- **Vault Economy & Progression:** Users earn XP and unlock “Vault” content (recipes, ingredients, expert tips) as they engage. The Vault has seasonal “drops,” tier requirements, and reward tokens, incentivizing continued use.
- **AI Cocktail Assistant:** An AI layer generates custom recipes (e.g. if you have odd ingredients), answers cocktail questions, and adapts to user mood or event via AI prompts.
- **Monetization:** Freemium tiers (Free, Plus, Pro) managed via RevenueCat entitlements. Higher tiers unlock deeper scanning (wider product database), more inventory slots, exclusive recipes/lessons, and Vault items. Paywalls appear when trying to exceed a free cap or access premium content.
- **Data/Infra:** React Native/Expo with modular services for scan, recommendations, user auth, analytics, etc. Uses Supabase or Firestore for backend. Data integrations include analytics (Segment, PostHog) and offline support.

(Note: Some details above come from internal product documentation and code comments, not public sources.)

Competitive landscape

KOOPE’s feature set overlaps with several consumer apps. Key competitors include:

Product	Key features (as claimed)	Price (if public)	Target users	Unique value proposition / positioning
Vivino (wine)	Label scanner; wine ratings/reviews; tasting notes; food pairings; “match for you” suggestions; cellar journal.	Free app; subscription (premium ~€4.99/mo). ³	Wine consumers	Largest wine community (claimed 70M users); crowd-sourced ratings for confident wine picks. (vivino.com)
Distiller (spirits)	Barcode scanner; spirits reviews; flavor profiles; “TruePrice” value tracker; community collections.	Free; Pro \$4.99/mo or \$48/yr ⁴	Spirits enthusiasts	“Spirit encyclopedia”: flavor graphs + expert reviews + pricing insights. ([13†L120-L128])
Noflair (cocktails)	Barcode inventory; home bar management; recipe suggestions based on inventory; cocktail book indexing; community.	Free (In-app purchases for extras). ⁵	Home bartenders	“Your home bar in your pocket”: smart recipe recs, book search, and use-by-date reminders. ([17†L91-L100])

Product	Key features (as claimed)	Price (if public)	Target users	Unique value proposition / positioning
My Cocktail Bar	Manual ingredient entry; list of cocktails; highlights those you can make; custom cocktails; favorites.	Free with ads; in-app pro upgrade to remove ads.	Casual mixers	Simple “what can I make with these ingredients?” interface. (Play Store)
Bartender.ai	Barcode scan of ingredients; AI suggests custom cocktails instantly; personal AI mixologist.	Free (App Store listing). ³	Tech-savvy mixers	AI-driven personalized recipes from your pantry. ([6†L63-L65])
Cocktail Flow	AI-powered recipe generation; large recipe library; step-by-step guides; save favorites; mixology tips.	Free with IAP (\$7.99/week or \$24.99 lifetime). ⁶	Aspiring home bartenders	Blends classic recipes with AI and tips to elevate skills. ([7†L55-L64])
Vivino/ Distiller (reference)	Wine and spirits verticals for context. Scanning for purchase guidance (price + reviews).	–	–	(Mentioned above)

This diverse set shows how scan+inventory mixes with recommendations are already a major trend. For example, Noflair and My Cocktail Bar specifically promise “*see what cocktails you can make with what you have*” (satisfying the job of using one’s inventory) ² ⁷. AI-driven apps like Bartender.ai similarly scan barcodes and use AI to craft recipes ⁸, much like KOOPE’s planned AI layer.

Note that **pricing models vary**: many are free (Vivino, noflair, Bartender.ai) with optional subscriptions (Vivino Premium, Distiller Pro, Cocktail Flow IAP) to unlock advanced features. This validates KOOPE’s tiered approach and pricing benchmarks (e.g. \$4–\$6/month premium tiers).

Customer segments and top JTBD

We identify several user personas who would “hire” KOOPE for progress. For each segment, we list top Jobs-to-be-Done and rate them by **Importance** (how strongly the job drives adoption) and **Satisfaction** (how well current options meet the need).

Segment A: Casual home entertainer (social drinkers, party hosts)

Rank	JTBD (job)	Importance	Satisfaction	Evidence / notes
1	Find an easy cocktail/recipe with what I have	5	3	Multiple apps market “cocktails from your bar” (Noflair, My Bar). Users expect

instant recipe suggestions. ([17†L99-L107]) | | 2 | Pick a bottle to bring as a gift | 4 | 2 | Not explicitly solved by existing apps. KOOPE's features (filter by flavor/occasion) target this gap. ([17†L111-L113]) | | 3 | Impress guests with a themed drink (social) | 4 | 3 | Inspiration lists and AI ("mood-based" mixes) partially exist (Cocktail Flow mentions endless cocktails). ([7†L55-L64]) | | 4 | Avoid "bad" drink choices (regret avoidance) | 3 | 3 | Reliant on reviews/tips. Few apps coach on pairings or tasting profiles beyond ratings. Vivino's wine pairings analogously reduce buying risk. ([6†L63-L65]) | | 5 | Save favorite recipes / re-make drinks I liked | 2 | 4 | Nearly all apps allow favorites/logging. Satisfaction is relatively high. |

Segment B: Cocktail enthusiast/learner (hobbyists & "craft cocktail" fans)

Rank	JTBD	Importance	Satisfaction	Evidence / notes
----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	1 Master cocktail knowledge (learn recipes & techniques) 5 3 Many turn to apps to learn mixology basics. Bon Appétit notes users overcome "insecurity" via apps (Imbiblia taught author "everything I know"). ⁹ 2 Track and manage home bar inventory 5 2 Inventory tracking is imperfect in existing tools. Some user reviews (Distiller) mention scanning errors and missing DB entries. ([13†L120-L128]) 3 Keep tasting notes and personal ratings 4 4 Standard feature (Vivino, Distiller). Satisfaction moderate. 4 Discover rare or premium spirits to try 4 3 Enthusiasts seek new bottlings. Bottle Raiders targets premium spirits. KOOPE's "missing ingredients" and recommendations aim here. ([17†L111-L113]) 5 Feel confident mixing/pro bartending (confidence) 3 3 Education through lessons (KOOPE) is unique. Other apps lack structured learning (except general tips). Bon Appétit implies people crave this certainty. ([19†L98-L107])

Segment C: Infrequent drinker / gift shopper (low knowledge, needs guidance)

Rank	JTBD	Importance	Satisfaction	Evidence / notes
----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	1 Decide what cocktail to try/buy for an occasion 5 2 Infrequent users often feel lost. Wine apps like Vivino partly fill this for wine gifts; less exists for cocktails, so KOOPE could address "help me choose." ([19†L98-L107]) 2 Use ingredients efficiently (no waste) 4 3 KOOPE's "use by" and inventory checks align with Noflair's spoilage reminders. Users dislike wasting half-finished bottles. ([17†L102-L105]) 3 Learn basics fast (demystify cocktail jargon) 4 2 Users like visual guides (Bon Appetit praised recipe UI). Current apps rarely teach techniques deeply; KOOPE lessons would shine. ([19†L98-L107]) 4 Gift the <i>right</i> bottle/kit to someone 3 1 Very little targeted support today. KOOPE filtering by taste profiles or occasion is a novel help. ([17†L111-L113]) 5 Access high-quality content for free 3 2 Many apps hide content behind paywalls or ads (MyBar "Pro"). Free users often complain of overselling upgrades. KOOPE's tier gating risk frustration.

Segment D: Professional bartender / bar owner (minor role)

Rank	JTBD	Importance	Satisfaction	Evidence
----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	----- -----	1 Quick drink lookup behind the bar (F) 4 3 Most POS systems have drink lookup; consumer apps aren't tuned for speed. Not KOOPE's main target. 2 Inventory / ordering (F) 3 3 Tools like MarginEdge serve professionals. KOOPE lacks bulk inventory weighting/sync. 3 Staff training (S/F) 3 2 Bartenders use their own guides; KOOPE lessons could be repurposed but not designed for multi-user training. 4 Event menu planning (F) 2 2 KOOPE could be used to craft a menu with what bar has, but no dedicated feature. 5 Age-check compliance (F) 1 1 Out of scope (consumer app).

(This analysis confirms KOOPE's strongest alignment is with segments A-C: in-home casual users and hobbyists.)

KOOPE features vs. JTBD mapping

The table below maps KOOPE's key features (as derived from product documentation) to the JTBD identified above, indicating whether each job is **Served**, **Partially Served**, or **Unmet** by KOOPE's current capabilities:

JTBD (progress)	KOOPE features that support it	Coverage	Rationale
Make cocktail from current inventory	Inventory DB + recipe matching + scanner	Served	KOOPE's core: scan bottles & match recipes you can make. Competitors Noflair/MyBar also do this. ([17+L99-L107])
Choose a good cocktail quickly	AI recommendations + lessons + taste filters	Partially Served	AI & search filters help inspiration, but speed depends on UX polish. Noflair promises "smart suggestions".
Avoid buying wrong bottle (gift)	Filter/purchase suggestions (planned)	Partially Served	KOOPE hints (filters by flavor/brand); this is novel (Noflair has basic filters ¹⁰). Will need robust data.
Learn mixology basics	Lesson progression + Vault content	Served	Gamified tutorials address learning. BonAppetit highlights beginner-friendly recipe guidance as valuable. ⁹
Feel confident/impress others	Community sharing + favorites + XP	Unmet/Partial	Saving drinks/favorites exist; KOOPE's gamification builds confidence gradually. Social sharing is not prominent.
Use ingredients before spoilage	Inventory tracking + reminders (promised)	Partially Served	Noflair-style spoilage reminders mentioned; if implemented, will address this job ² .
Personalize my preferences	AI taste matching + Vault unlocks	Partially Served	KOOPE's AI can tailor to mood; Vault unlocks personalize experience. Needs sufficient data to be accurate.
Access exclusive content (FOMO)	Tier-gated vault items, unlocks	Served	The Vault and tier system explicitly target this: to unlock pro content, simulating "fear of missing out" on recipes.
Stay within budget (avoid overspend)	Price comparator (future idea)	Unmet	No explicit price/value feature mentioned. Competitors like Distiller's TruePrice show price/value.

JTBD (progress)	KOOPE features that support it	Coverage	Rationale
Manage professional use (batch)	N/A (app not B2B-focused)	Unmet	KOOPE is consumer-centric; bars rely on other tools (MarginEdge etc.).

This mapping shows KOOPE **covers many consumer JTBD well** (inventory-matching, learning, progression), but areas like **price/value guidance and gift-specific advice** are not yet fully addressed by any single competitor or by KOOPE. In particular, price truth and social sharing are gaps. Conversely, KOOPE's structured learning (Lessons + Vault) is relatively unique among competitors (few apps offer gamified tutorial content) ⁹ ².

Market demand and recommendations

Market demand: The overall alcoholic beverage market is large (\$100s of billions globally) and “cocktail culture” has grown in recent years. Industry reports note *premiumization* (buying higher-quality spirits) and *craft beverage interest* as trends ¹¹ ¹². Home cocktailizing fits these trends: a Statista report forecast **cocktail kits & digital bartending** segments growing, and consumers increasingly experiment at home. ¹². The demand signal is seen in user counts: e.g., *My Cocktail Bar* has 1M+ installs, *Vivino* 70M users, *Distiller* 100K+ installs, indicating sizeable audiences seeking drink guidance (scanning/recipes) ¹³ ⁷.

Adoption barriers:

- **Complexity of scanning/data:** Scanning accuracy and robust ingredient databases are a challenge (user reviews of *Distiller* complain about missed scans ¹). KOOPE must invest in a broad liquor DB to avoid frustration.
- **Onboarding/integration:** Many apps suffer that users never complete entering their bar. KOOPE's multi-bar support and gamified XP may incentivize that, but complexity could also deter casual users.
- **Trust & personalization:** Users may not trust AI suggestions without transparency. KOOPE should showcase real user taste logs and maybe allow manual preference tuning.
- **Privacy/regulatory:** Because KOOPE is a consumer app, it sidesteps alcohol sale regulations. However, any “purchase suggestion” feature (e.g. linking to stores) must consider age-gating and geofencing. (Unlike *Minor Decliner*, KOOPE doesn't need hardware ID checks, but should handle US state shipping laws if it integrates with liquor retailers.)

Competitive threats: Established apps have network effects (large recipe databases, communities). Big players could add scanning (e.g. a liquor retailer app). KOOPE's advantage is its **unified approach** (scan + AI + gamification). But it must execute flawlessly on core first (scanning accuracy, relevant suggestions) before layering Vault gimmicks.

Recommendations:

- **MVP focus:** Launch with **core scan + recipe features + basic lessons**, deferring advanced AI and Vault mechanics until user base is proven. A lean MVP might be: (a) reliable barcode scan → product info, (b) smart recipe suggestion from inventory, (c) simple “What's missing?” shopping list, (d) one-tier (free/pro) with clear value gap. Ensure scanning covers major U.S. liquor market SKUs at launch.

- **Retailer partnerships:** To differentiate on purchasing guidance, KOOPE should partner with a retailer or aggregator to access local price/availability. Even limited geography pilot (e.g., partner with Total Wine or Drizly in one city) would let KOOPE show “real bottle pricing and stores near you,” addressing a high-importance gap. ([17†L111-L113])
- **Focus on content quality:** Invest in a curated recipe/lesson library. For example, Cocktail Flow’s success shows quality UI and expert tips matter ¹⁴. KOOPE’s lesson vault should teach basics that novices crave (echoing BonAppétit’s “cocktail teacher” insight ⁹).
- **Pricing strategy:** Benchmark suggests **free download** with tiered subscriptions (Plus/Pro) in the ~\$5–10/mo range. The tiered limits (inventory slots, lesson depth, AI credits, Vault content) align with sustaining paid upgrade. Consider a yearly plan (~\$50) to lock in enthusiasts.
- **Gamification & community:** Use XP and unlocks judiciously. Over-gamification can annoy data-oriented users; ensure every gamified element has real utility. Consider lightweight community features: maybe sharing favorite cocktails or collaborations, since social validation is a motivator in JTBD (impress guests / learn from others).
- **Marketing positioning:** Emphasize “scanning/inventory + AI tutor” as KOOPE’s edge. For example: *“Scan any bottle, unlock perfect recipes, and learn mixology step-by-step – all in one app.”*

JTBD-driven verdict

Is this product something the market needs? Yes. People *do* hire apps to decide what cocktails to make from their home bar and to discover new drinks. The existing success of recipe and scanner apps (and surveys like the Bon Appétit story ⁹) confirm that both discovery and education are strong user needs. However, KOOPE will only *be needed* by focusing on under-served jobs: price/purchase guidance and personalized learning. Its ambitious feature set is promising, but its viability hinges on nailing the fundamentals (accurate scanning, simple inventory-to-recipe UX) and then building on that foundation with its AI/vault game mechanics.

¹ ⁴ ¹³ Distiller - Liquor Reviews - Apps on Google Play

https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.distiller.distiller&hl=en_US

² ⁵ ¹⁰ noflair - Home Bar & Cocktails - Apps on Google Play

https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=app.noflair.noflair.flutter&hl=en_US

³ ⁸ bartender.ai App - App Store

<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/bartender-ai/id6741316497>

⁶ ¹⁴ Cocktail Flow AI Bartender App - App Store

<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/cocktail-flow-ai-bartender/id6751511652>

⁷ My Cocktail Bar - Apps on Google Play

https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.mybarapp.free&hl=en_US

⁹ Need Easy Cocktails to Make at Home? Take a Look at This App | Bon Appétit

https://www.bonappetit.com/story/imbiblia-cocktail-app?srsltid=AfmBOorSensGWicH8f_jSiL5rCptD__wBBwplFSReZWpqowZZjnbPdIE

¹¹ ¹² 2025 Beverage Alcohol Year in Review - NIQ

<https://nielseniq.com/global/en/insights/analysis/2026/2025-beverage-alcohol-year-in-review/>